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International Attorneys
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MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING (MOU)

BETWEEN

SURANA & SURANA INTERNATIONAL ATTORNEYS

AND

KALINGA UNIVERSITY, RAIPUR

This MOU is entered into on the 21st day of May 2024 by and between

Surana & Surana International Attorneys (hereinafter called "SSIA") situated at International Law Centre, 61-63, Dr. Radhakrishnan Salai, Mylapore, Chennai 600 004, Tamil Nadu, a law firm engaged in providing professional legal & consulting services in India & abroad and a pioneer in organizing International / National level moot court competitions incorporating best practices.

and

Kalinga University, Raipur (hereinafter called "KU"), established in 2013 has emerged as a Centre of Excellence of higher education in Central India. Strategically located in the Smart City, situated at Kotni, Near Mantralaya, Naya Raipur 492 101, Chhattisgarh and meritorious students from all over the Country and various Countries from South Asia & Africa, study here.

The aforesaid parties are hereinafter collectively referred to as "the Organisers".

1. **Objective of the MOU**

   a. SSIA and KU agree to jointly conduct a Surana and Surana National Human Rights Law Moot Court Competition by Kalinga University, Raipur subject to and in accordance with, the terms contained in this MOU in letter and spirit.

   b. The joint emphasis should be on an efficiently administered, transparent & academically intensive competition.

2. **Title of the Competition**

   The title of the competitions shall be

   "Surana and Surana JUDEX 2.0 National Human Rights Law Moot Court Competition."

   Change of title will not be considered at any point of time, however the JUDEX version X.X (ie., 2.0) can be done on incremental while organizing events year on year.

3. **Mode of the Competition :** can be conducted in any of the following

   a. **Hybrid :**

      i. The Preliminary rounds & Octa Final rounds will be conducted **Virtually** followed by the Quarter Final, Semi-Final & Finals **On Campus** **(Or)**

      ii. The Preliminary rounds, Octa Final & / Quarter Final rounds will be conducted **Virtually** followed by the Semi-Final & Finals **On Campus**

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b. **Virtually :** All rounds will be conducted **Online**

c. **Physical :** All rounds will be conducted **On Campus**

4. A. National Human Rights Law Moot Court Competition

a. Create awareness on Human Rights Law in a systematic / scientific manner and train participants for effective practice.

b. Facilitate the evolution of Human Rights Law through the jurisprudential analysis of the existing law and consequential emergence of new laws.

B. Online Publication of Case & Winning Memorials

It is proposed to publish periodically, all the Moot Propositions and Top 4 winning memorials. This will contain the list of teams participated each year, the complete results, the name of the dignitaries etc. with the view of providing a reference manual for the students on the subject of Human Rights Law).

The publication will be jointly done by Surana & Surana & Kalinga University, Raipur.

5. Duration of the MOU

This joint venture is agreed to be held Virtually / Hybrid (Online & On Campus) / Physically for a period of **3 years** and may be curtailed or extended on mutual satisfaction. This MoU is valid for the Academic Year 2024-25 to 2026-27.

6. Joint Organizers Role & Obligations

A. **Surana & Surana International Attorneys (SSIA):**

i. SSIA will give a sum of Rs.1.00 lakh (Rupees one lakh only) every year for Physical / Hybrid mode, if the competition is conducted with a 10% increase in each subsequent edition. If conducted Virtually, a sum of Rs.50,000/- (Rupees Fifty Thousand only) for the Academic year would be given.

ii. The entire administration of the moot will be handled by SSIA at its own cost.

iii. Administrator(s) from SSIA will travel to KU (the venue) during the competition at their own cost.

iv. SSIA administrator(s) will do the orientation of the teams / court assistants / court managers, briefing of the judges, on Scoring, processing & declaration of Results.

v. Moot administration is web based and completely automated through a proprietary software developed by SSIA

vi. All participating teams will register online at www.moot.in. The Account details will be provided by the Kalinga University for the payment of registration fee.

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vii. SSIA will share / provide all the details of the moot to KU (like list of teams registered / fixtures / judges / printouts of all score sheets of various rounds / individual score sheets of teams / final results etc.) during and after the competition as required.

viii. All the above information will also be made available at www.moot.in

ix. SSIA will provide all the stationery items for the competition (i.e. folders / badges / notepads / pens / pencils etc.)

x. SSIA will provide logistics like

a. All certificates (participants / winners of various categories / judges / volunteers)

b. All scoring formats

c. Plaques for the certificates of winners under various categories

xi. The draft of all the scoring formats, certificates etc. with the logos of SSIA & KU will be sent in advance for approval. On confirmation, SSIA will print all the required documents in the standard format for the administration of the competition and send it to KU well in advance.

xii. SSIA will frame the rules of the competition based on the content and spirit of the MOU & annexure to the MOU and send it to KU for approval before uploading the same on www.moot.in

xiii. SSIA will promote the event through its Academic Initiatives website functioning in the name & style of www.moot.in and also through the LinkedIn, Facebook & Instagram pages with adequate coverage and exposure for KU.

xiv. SSIA shall have no further obligation.

B. Kalinga University, Raipur (KU):

i. KU will bear the entire cost of the competition

ii. KU may decide upon the cash prize component and the registration fee for the competition. Registration fee so charged shall be Rs. 2000/- per team for the initial year and is subject to change for the subsequent years.

iii. Invite competent judges knowledgeable in the subject for all oral rounds of the competition. Arrange for evaluation of the memorials by a minimum two judges (as detailed in **Clause 9. Jury, criteria and evaluation of Memorials & Oral rounds**). SSIA will assist by providing a list of judges who may be invited.

iv. KU shall frame the problem/proposition for the competition. SSIA will assist in whetting /finalizing it. The draft of the proposition must be ready at least 3 months before start of competition and should be released to the Participants well before 2 months of the Competition.

v. Case / problem of moot be sent to invited judges in advance so that judges are well prepared.

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vi. Try and muster participation of minimum 24 teams for the competition. To send invitation to all Law Colleges throughout the country by email and promote through digital & social media platforms.

vii. Ensure cooperation of the faculty, administrative staff and students

viii. Provide the infrastructure like Auditorium, requisite number of court halls, waiting rooms for judges and teams. (full details provided in annexure)

ix. Arrange for prominent dignitaries for the Inaugural / Finals / Valediction

x. Arrange for

   a. Accommodation (participants and outstation judges),

   b. Food, (all participants, judges, volunteers and administrative staff)

   c. Transport (for the participants and the outstation judges from the accommodation to the venue and back)

   d. Photography & video

ix. SSIA logo (Firm Logo & Academic Initiative Logo) shall be featured prominently in all official communications, brochures, invitations and pamphlets in respect of the competition along with the logo of KU and other Sponsors if any. The same will be sent for review & approval to SSIA.

x. In all communications, banners, stage backdrops, souvenirs and pamphlets, the promotion of the competition shall be "**Kalinga University, Raipur**, Faculty of Law, Welcomes You To **"Surana and Surana JUDEX 2.0 National Human Rights Law Moot Court Competition".**

xi. KU to arrange for Live Streaming of the Finals on YouTube, Instagram under "Surana & Surana" and its links to be provided by SSIA.

xii. Arrange for good press coverage of the inauguration, finals & valediction functions of the event.

xiii. Strictly adhere to the SSIA policy of serving only vegetarian food and that no alcohol or tobacco products shall be made available / utilised / promoted during the competition.

xiv. KU must send individual invitations to all prominent institutions / law colleges and motivate institutions throughout our country to participate in the moot. Extra effort must be made to invite teams from remote areas like Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh, North-Eastern states etc. which will be much appreciated.

xv. Provide SSIA the name, address, email id's and the phone numbers of all the judges of the competition and of the dignitaries invited.

xvi. Provide SSIA the photographs (soft copy) / news reports / clippings of the final rounds & the valedictory ceremony. Further use, exhibition and distribution of these materials, electronically or otherwise, shall be right of SSIA & KU.

xvii. KU agrees to issue a receipt for the amount received from SSIA.

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7. Prizes (You can choose to vary the prize money)

a. The following cash prizes may be awarded (KU may decide on the cash component)

1) Winning Team	Rs. 21,000
2) Runner up Team	Rs. 11,000
3) Best Memorial	Rs. 8,000
4) Best Student Advocate	Rs. 6,000
5) Best Researcher (In case a Researcher Test is Conducted) Or Second Best Memorial can be considered if Researcher Test is not organized.	Rs. 4,000

The amount of the cash prizes is subject to change.

b. Every participant will get a participation certificate issued jointly by SSIA & KU

c. All winners will be given the respective certificates and plaques as per rules.

d. The Third and Fourth placed Teams / Memorials / Best students and the Best speaker of the finals will be awarded respective certificates.

8. Teams

We must aim to get minimum 24 teams.

Each team shall consist of 3 members only.

Host team can participate subject to the conditions of transparency and neutral judges from other states. However, the home team may not become eligible for the cash prizes and will not proceed beyond the Preliminary rounds of the competition. KU may consider special prizes / certificates for the home team if they reach the Octa Finals / Quarter finals.

9. Rounds

"Surana and Surana JUDEX 2.0 National Human Rights Law Moot Court Competition" will have

2 preliminary rounds / a Quarter final (8 teams) / a Semi final (4 teams) / and Final (Quarter finals if registered teams are 16 & above & Octa final rounds if registered teams are 30 & above)

10. Jury, criteria and evaluation of Memorials & Oral rounds

a. Preliminary Oral Rounds / Octa-Finals / Quarter-Finals A minimum of 2 and a maximum of 3 members consisting of advocates / members of the bar, associates from law firms and academicians well versed in the subject.

b. Semi-finals The jury will consist of a minimum of 2 members comprising at least one sitting / retired Judge or senior advocate, a distinguished academician.

c. Finals will consist of a distinguished bench of 3 members consisting of Sitting/retired judges of Supreme Court / High Court, leader of the bar, senior advocates, renowned experts / academician from the subject area.

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d. Memorials for the moot will be evaluated by a distinguished panel of at least two impartial judges, preferably a mixture of academicians and practicing advocates.

e. In case of evaluation of the memorials entries through soft copies, the printout of the email forwarding the scores sheets must be attached along.

11. Additional sponsors

To make this project more inclusive we may pursue / consider sponsorship from good and reputed professionals (senior advocates, retired judges, corporate counsel) / organisations (non law firms, bar associations, publishing companies etc.). Accepting sponsorship from individual / entity must be agreed to by both parties. Sponsors role will be restricted to:

i. Display of logos provided by them on competition brochure and banners.
ii. Mention about their sponsorship in opening and closing ceremonies
iii. Large reputed sponsors in the profession may be allowed to judge prelims /quarter finals/Semi Finals, share dais with dignitaries
iv. The sponsors will have no role in the conduct / organisation of the competition, nor will be entitled for any particulars about participants / judges, which rests solely with the joint organisers.

12. Copyright

The copyright over the memorials / judgments submitted for participation in the competition is assigned by participants and shall vest completely and fully in SSIA & KU. Further use, exhibition and distribution of these materials, electronically or otherwise, shall also be the exclusive right of SSIA & KU.

13. Signed in Duplicate in Chennai

This MOU is executed in duplicate with each copy being an official version and having equal legal validity. By signing below, the Organisers acting by their duly authorized officers have caused this Memorandum of Understanding to be executed, effective as of the day and year first above written.

Mr. Preetam Surana
Partner - Dispute Resolution Practice &
Head - Academic Initiatives
Surana & Surana International Attorneys
Mylapore, Chennai 600 004

Dr. Sandeep Gandhi
Registrar
Kalinga University
Naya Raipur 492 101

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Annexure

Logistics worked out in expectation of about 30 - 40 teams (Virtual Moot) and 16 or 8 Teams (On Campus Moots)

Teams: Each team must have only 3 members (min 2 & max 3). The organizers will provide food and accommodation during the period of the competition.

Competition Administration

A. **SSIA** will undertake the complete administration of the competition.

B. **KU** will provide all required infrastructure and will bear the entire cost of the competition. SSIA will pay a sum of Rs. 1 lakh (Hybrid / Physical) by cheque with a 10% increase in each subsequent edition or Rs. 50,000 (Virtual) to KU by cheque for that Academic year will be given.

Receiving and Valuation of Memorials

KU will receive the advance copy of the memorials and arrange for evaluation. The registered teams would be required to send at least one copy (soft & hard copy) of the **Applicant** and **Respondent** memorials within the deadline mentioned in the rules and regulations. Such memorials be received and evaluated by KU, (by senior professors or competent lawyers or any judges from outside who are experts in the field), before the competition and the marks shall be made available to the administrator on the day the competition begins.

Court Halls

1. 8 - 20 court halls are required depending on the number of teams registered and mode of the Competition
2. Court halls should have one table (to seat 2 – 3 judges) and two or three chairs (as required)
3. Two tables and eight chairs for the participants and a podium for the speaker facing the judges. Two chairs and a table to be provided for court officers
4. Enough seating is to be provided for audience (optional).
5. The Finals preferably, has to take place in an auditorium (College auditorium will do) / big hall with a stage with Public Address system for the judges and contestants. There should be adequate seats for the audience.

Waiting room for judges and participants

1. Waiting room for the judges
2. Waiting room(s) for the participants

Judges

1. The requirement is a minimum of 30 - 40 judges per round for the preliminaries on Saturday. (About 45 judges for preliminaries would be ideal as some judges may leave after judging one or two rounds). The numbers given are tentative and increase or decrease depends on the number of teams participating.
2. We may ensure that maximum judges are invited from in and around and in case of need from other places.
3. Each judge may be requested to judge 2 – 4 rounds each.

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4. 2 Sessions pre-lunch and 2 sessions post lunch (subject to number of court halls and number of teams
5. Invite judges for the competition from members of judiciary, bar, academic community, the Law Ministry etc.
6. Invite sitting / retired Supreme Court / High Court judges / Advocate General / Solicitor General, senior members of the Bar, academia etc. to judge the semi-final and final rounds.
7. It is desirable to have one or two extra judges in case, some judges have to suddenly leave.
8. Case/problem for the moot must be sent to invited judges in advance, so that they are prepared.

Chief Guest & Dignitaries

1. Arrange for Two top chief guests; one each for opening and closing ceremonies. (State Chief Justice / Supreme Court Justice / sitting State Judges and one Subject Expert relevant to the Topic of Competition)
2. Ensure that opening and closing ceremonies are well attended (by members of higher judiciary, lower judiciary, faculty, members of the Bar, parents of students studying in your institution etc.)

Accommodation

Basic, respectable and economical accommodation has to be provided to all outstation participants and outstation judges. It is preferable to have the accommodation near the venue of the competition.

Transport

Transport has to be provided to the judges and the participants if the accommodation is away from the venue of the competition. A van / bus can be arranged to pick and drop them depending on the number of participants.

Food

Breakfast, tea, snacks, lunch & dinner has to be provided to all participants and volunteers. Only vegetarian food shall be served. No alcohol or tobacco products be made available / utilised / promoted during the competition.

Volunteers

We need student volunteers to assist the organizers

1.	Court assistants (20 courts X 2)	40 + 5 (additional members in case of need)
2.	Scoring assistant	2
3.	Exchange of memorials	2
4.	Co-ordination with court assistants	2
5.	Co-ordination with teams	5
6.	Co-ordination with judges	5
7.	Assistance during registration (Friday)	2
8.	Assistance during prize distribution (Sunday)	2

		65

All volunteers will get a certificate of appreciation. The numbers given above are minimum and tentative and may increase or decrease depend on the number of teams participating. It is presumed the volunteers will be there for all the rounds. Otherwise more volunteers are needed.

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List of items that will be brought / arranged by Surana & Surana

Total administration and management of the competition will be done by Surana & Surana team. Our team will conduct the competition as per international standards. The following will be taken care of by us.

1. Certificates for all winners, participants, volunteers
2. Trophies for winners of different prizes (plaques)
3. Copies of moot court case & rules
4. Software for Moot Court Competition management
5. All formats for judging oral rounds & memorials, Instructions to court clerks and volunteers and participant registration details
6. Orientation of the teams
7. Briefing the court clerks / managers
8. Briefing the judges
9. Scoring formats
    a. Oral pleading score sheet
    b. Memorial content score sheet (soft copy will be sent to you in advance)
    c. Memorial penalty score sheet (soft copy will be sent to you in advance)
    d. Guidelines to court clerks
    e. Feedback forms
    f. Spirit of Surana Forms

To be organized (made available) by KU

1. Problem / proposition of the moot at least 3 months before the competition.
2. Court halls with requisite tables and chairs and a podium (for judges and participants)
3. Waiting room for judges and participants
4. A separate control room with a computer with Inkjet or laser printer.
5. Adequate number of Judges
6. Accommodation for participants and outstation judges
7. Volunteers
8. Breakfast, coffee / tea, snacks, lunch & dinner for all participants, volunteers, judges, faculty and administrative staff involved in the competition
9. Transport for judges and participants in case, place of stay is away from the venue
10. Public address system for inauguration, finals and valediction in the auditorium.
11. Stationery for printing score sheets, time sheets etc.
12. Advance receipt and evaluation of memorials
13. Live streaming of Finals in YouTube, Instagram ; links to be provided by SSIA

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